RBI Grade B Officer

Complete Syllabus - Phase 1 & Phase 2

Topic-wise checklist for the General (DR) stream · every subject, every topic, tick-box tracker

1. Exam at a glance

Stage	Papers / Sections	Marks	Time	Nature
Phase 1 (Prelims)	General Awareness (80 Q), Quantitative Aptitude (30 Q), English Language (30 Q), Reasoning Ability (60 Q)	200	120 min (total)	Objective MCQ, -0.25 per wrong answer. **Qualifying only** - not counted in final merit
Phase 2 (Mains)	Paper I: Economic & Social Issues (ESI)	100	120 min	Objective + Descriptive
	Paper II: English (Writing Skills)	100	90 min	Descriptive, typed on screen
	Paper III: Finance & Management (FM)	100	120 min	Objective + Descriptive
Interview	Personality test	75	-	Final merit = Phase 2 (300) + Interview (75) = 375

Negative marking (-0.25) applies to the objective portions of Phase 1 and Phase 2; descriptive portions carry no negative marking.

2. How to use this guide

Each topic has a tick-box so you can track progress. Part A covers the four Phase 1 sections, Part B covers the three Phase 2 papers, and the last pages list high-weightage areas, key reports and a revision order.

Contents

Part	Subject	Phase
A1	General Awareness	Phase 1
A2	Quantitative Aptitude	Phase 1
A3	English Language	Phase 1
A4	Reasoning Ability	Phase 1
B1	Economic & Social Issues (ESI)	Phase 2 - Paper I
B2	English (Writing Skills)	Phase 2 - Paper II
B3	Finance & Management (FM)	Phase 2 - Paper III
C	High-weightage areas, key reports, interview focus	All stages

Note: RBI's notification lists Phase 1 only by subject name; the topic breakdown below follows the standard syllabus used for the exam and recent papers, and the Phase 2 outline follows the notification. Always confirm against the latest official notification at rbi.org.in / opportunities.rbi.org.in. DEPR and DSIM streams have separate papers and are not covered here.

PART A - PHASE 1 (PRELIMS)

200 questions | 200 marks | 120 minutes | qualifying stage

A1. General Awareness (80 questions)

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**Current Affairs**	Last 6-8 months: national and international news, banking and RBI updates, policies, reports, summits, appointments, awards.
☐	**Banking & Financial Awareness**	Basics of banking, monetary policy (Repo, Reverse Repo, CRR, SLR), financial institutions, Basel norms, NPAs, PCA framework, financial inclusion, RBI circulars and recent regulatory changes.
☐	**Economy & Budget**	Economic Survey, Union Budget, government economic policies, key economic terms and concepts.
☐	**Government Schemes**	Major central schemes, their objectives and target beneficiaries (e.g. PM-JAY, SVAMITVA, Digital India).
☐	**Reports & Indices**	GDP, inflation, Human Development Index, Global Hunger Index, World Economic Outlook, Global Financial Stability Report and similar rankings.
☐	**Static GK**	Important places, organisations, books and historical facts; banks' headquarters and taglines; countries' capitals and currencies; important days.

A2. Quantitative Aptitude (30 questions)

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**Simplification & Approximation**	Quick calculations using BODMAS, fractions, surds and indices.
☐	**Number Series**	Missing number and wrong number series; pattern finding.
☐	**Data Interpretation**	Tables, bar graphs, line graphs, pie charts, caselet DI, mixed graphs.
☐	**Quadratic Equations**	Solving for roots and comparing x and y; quantity comparison (Q1 vs Q2).
☐	**Percentage & Average**	Percentage change, successive percentages, weighted averages.
☐	**Ratio, Proportion & Partnership**	Ratio and proportion, variation, ages, partnership.
☐	**Profit, Loss & Discount**	Cost price, selling price, marked price, successive discounts.
☐	**Simple & Compound Interest**	Interest calculations, growth patterns, difference between SI and CI.
☐	**Time & Work**	Work efficiency, pipes and cisterns, alternate-day work.
☐	**Time, Speed & Distance**	Relative speed, trains, boats and streams, races, circular motion.
☐	**Mixture & Allegation**	Combining ratios and quantities, replacement problems.
☐	**Mensuration & Miscellaneous**	Area, perimeter, volume of standard figures; permutation, combination and probability basics.

A3. English Language (30 questions)

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**Reading Comprehension**	Passage-based questions testing understanding, inference, tone and vocabulary in context.
☐	**Cloze Test**	Fill in the blanks in a passage using context and grammar.
☐	**Error Detection**	Spotting grammatical mistakes in sentences.
☐	**Para Jumbles**	Arranging sentences in a logical order.
☐	**Vocabulary**	Synonyms, antonyms, word usage.
☐	**Sentence Improvement**	Correcting sentence structure and grammar.
☐	**Fill in the Blanks**	Single and double fillers based on vocabulary and context.
☐	**Phrase Replacement**	Replacing incorrect phrases with the correct ones.
☐	**Word Swap**	Interchanging words to form meaningful sentences.
☐	**Idioms & Phrases**	Understanding figurative meanings.
☐	**Paragraph Completion**	Completing an incomplete passage logically (sentence rearrangement).

A4. Reasoning Ability (60 questions)

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**Puzzles & Seating Arrangement**	Linear, circular, square, floor-based and box-based arrangements (highest weightage).
☐	**Syllogism**	Drawing logical conclusions from statements, including new-pattern questions.
☐	**Coding-Decoding**	Pattern-based transformations of words and numbers.
☐	**Inequality**	Direct and coded inequality questions.
☐	**Blood Relations**	Family-tree and relationship problems.
☐	**Input-Output**	Machine-based step-wise arrangement patterns.
☐	**Direction & Distance**	Tracking movement and final position.
☐	**Order & Ranking**	Position-based problems in a sequence.
☐	**Alphanumeric Series**	Mixed letter-number pattern questions.
☐	**Data Sufficiency**	Deciding whether the given data is enough to answer.
☐	**Logical Reasoning**	Statement-based questions: assumptions, inferences, course of action, strengthening and weakening arguments.
☐	**Cause & Effect**	Identifying relationships between events.

PART B - PHASE 2 (MAINS)

3 papers x 100 marks = 300 marks | counted in final merit

B1. Paper I - Economic & Social Issues (100 marks, 120 min)

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**1. Growth & Development**	Measurement of growth: national income and per capita income; role and share of agriculture, industry and services in GDP; industrial and labour policy.
☐	**2. Poverty & Employment**	Concepts and measurement of poverty, poverty alleviation programmes, employment generation, unemployment.
☐	**3. Sustainable Development**	Environmental issues, climate change, sustainability practices.
☐	**4. Economic Reforms**	Liberalisation, privatisation, globalisation (LPG); role of public and private sectors; recent reforms.
☐	**5. Money, Banking & Public Finance**	Monetary policy, fiscal policy, inflation, financial sector reforms, capital markets, FDI and foreign aid, Union Budget, taxation.
☐	**6. Globalisation**	Opening up of the Indian economy, balance of payments, EXIM policy, IMF, World Bank, WTO, regional economic cooperation.
☐	**7. Social Structure in India**	Multiculturalism, demographic trends, urbanisation and migration, gender issues, social justice, positive discrimination for the underprivileged, social movements.
☐	**8. Indian Political System**	Governance structure, public policy and policy-making.
☐	**9. Human Development & Social Sector**	Health, education, welfare schemes, social sector initiatives, human development indicators.
☐	**10. Frequently asked areas**	Agriculture, MSME sector, urbanisation, labour reforms, financial inclusion, digital economy.

Key reports for ESI: Economic Survey, Union Budget, Human Development Report, World Development Report, RBI Annual Report, IMF World Economic Outlook.

B2. Paper II - English, Writing Skills (100 marks, 90 min)

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**Essay Writing**	Structured essays on economic, social or current topics with clear arguments.
☐	**Precis Writing**	Summarising a passage concisely while keeping the core idea.
☐	**Reading Comprehension**	Understanding passages and answering descriptive questions.
☐	**Business / Office Correspondence**	Formal letters and emails in a professional tone.

B3. Paper III - Finance & Management (100 marks, 120 min)

Part 1: Finance

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**Financial System**	Structure of the Indian financial system, financial intermediaries, instruments, and regulators.
☐	**RBI & Institutions**	Functions of RBI; NABARD, SIDBI, EXIM Bank, NHB and other institutions.
☐	**Financial Markets**	Money market, capital market, forex market, bond and equity markets.
☐	**Risk Management**	Banking risks and mitigation strategies; Basel norms; NPAs.
☐	**Derivatives**	Basics of forwards, futures, options and swaps.
☐	**Banking Sector Trends**	Reforms, digital transformation, payment systems, innovations.
☐	**Financial Inclusion**	Role of technology in inclusive banking.
☐	**Public Finance**	Union Budget, direct and indirect taxes, GST.
☐	**Fiscal Policy**	FRBM Act, Finance Commission.
☐	**Inflation**	CPI, WPI, trends, causes and control measures.
☐	**Corporate Governance**	Governance practices in the banking sector.
☐	**PPP & Investments**	Public-private partnerships, portfolio investment.

Part 2: Management

	Topic	What to cover
☐	**Management Basics**	Nature, scope and functions of management.
☐	**Management Process**	Planning, organising, staffing, directing, controlling.
☐	**Leadership**	Styles, theories and the role of leadership.
☐	**Human Resource Development**	HRD concepts, training, performance appraisal.
☐	**Motivation & Morale**	Theories (Maslow, Herzberg, McGregor), incentives, employee satisfaction.
☐	**Communication**	Types, process, barriers, role of IT in communication.
☐	**Organisational Behaviour**	Role of managers, team dynamics, decision-making, conflict management.
☐	**Corporate Governance & Ethics**	Principles, mechanisms and impact on organisations.

PART C - PRIORITIES, REPORTS & INTERVIEW

Phase 1 high-weightage areas (typical expected questions)

Section	High-weightage areas	Expected Qs
General Awareness	Current affairs, economic and national (25-35); banking and financial awareness (15-25); government schemes (7-10); reports and indices (5-8)	~50-80
Reasoning	Seating arrangement and puzzles (20-40); logical reasoning (8-10); machine input-output (~5); syllogism (3-5); coding, direction, blood relations (5-10)	~60
Quantitative Aptitude	Data interpretation and caselets (10-15); arithmetic (8-12); number series (4-6); quadratic equations (1-5); quantity comparison (2-5)	~30
English Language	Reading comprehension (8-15); para jumbles (4-5); fillers (4-5); error detection (4-6); vocabulary (4-6); miscellaneous (5-9)	~30

Ranges are indicative, based on analysis of recent papers; they vary year to year.

Phase 2 priority topics

Paper	Topics that come up most often
ESI	Inflation, monetary and fiscal policy; poverty, unemployment, sustainable development; economic reforms; globalisation (WTO, IMF, World Bank); Budget and Economic Survey; social issues (education, health, gender, demographics); financial inclusion and digital economy.
FM - Finance	Indian financial system and RBI functions; money, capital, forex and bond markets; Basel norms, risk management, NPAs; repo, reverse repo, CRR, SLR; financial inclusion and digital payments; derivatives; inflation and fiscal policy.
FM - Management	Leadership theories and styles; motivation theories; communication process and barriers; HRD and performance appraisal; organisational behaviour; corporate governance and ethics; functions of management; decision-making and conflict management.

Interview (75 marks)

Assesses personality, awareness and communication. Focus on banking awareness, economic issues, your personal and academic background, and clear communication.

Suggested revision order

Step	Focus
1	Phase 1: daily current affairs and banking awareness; practise puzzles and DI for speed. Aim to clear the cut-off comfortably - it is qualifying only.
2	Phase 2 ESI and FM: build concepts from standard sources, then practise descriptive answers (structure, examples, current data).
3	Writing: weekly essay and precis practice, typed on screen to match exam conditions.
4	Final stretch: previous-year papers, mocks, and interview preparation using the Economic Survey, Budget and RBI Annual Report.

Sources and accuracy: topic structure compiled from the RBI Grade B notification outline as reproduced by BankersAdda (updated Oct 2026), cross-checked with Adda247, Oliveboard and other prep sites. The official syllabus is indicative and RBI may change the pattern; the next cycle is expected to be notified in early 2027, so verify details on the official RBI recruitment page before relying on this guide.